

09/10/2026

SLOT-C

ITA 1435 - ETHICAL HACKING

MAHIMA

192521280

COI - ASSESSMENT

TOOLS - AT-3

INTRODUCTION:

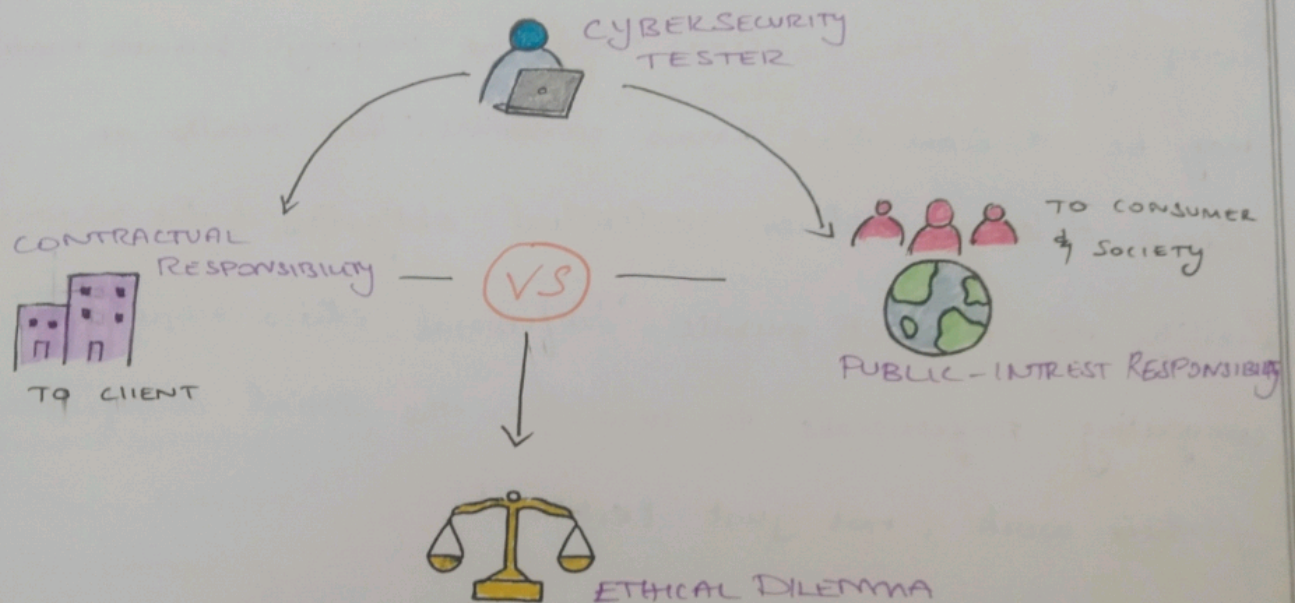
A cybersecurity professional may sometimes discover information that goes beyond the technical purpose of an assignment. In this case, a security tester is hired by a company, he/she realizes that the company's business model may be a scam that harms consumers. This creates an ethical dilemma between contractual obligations & the responsibility to protect public. Professional ethics requires computing professionals to consider the social consequences of their work, not just technical.

2. ETHICAL ISSUE & CONFLICT:

The main conflict between client confidentiality and public interest. As a contracted tester, the professional must follow the agreed scope, protect confidential information and avoid unauthorized investigations.

However, ignoring credible evidence of serious consumer harm may also be ethically wrong.

The tester must distinguish between suspicion & verified evidence. An unusual business model does not automatically prove fraud. Therefore, observations should be documented accurately, without making unsupported accusations.



3) PROFESSIONAL RESPONSIBILITY & REPORTING.

Although the tester's role is purely technical, professional responsibility does not end with identifying vulnerabilities. Serious tasks discovered during authorised work should

be communicated to appropriate people.

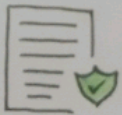
The tester should initially report the concern to the engagement manager. If the issue is significant, it shall be escalated to the company's legal, compliance, risk-management team. If credible evidence of serious illegal activity remains unaddressed, the tester may consider reporting to regulatory authority or law-enforcement agency



1. Document & verify findings



2. Report to Engagement manager / Project Lead



3. Escalate to Legal / Compliance / Senior management



4. Report to External authority



5. Public Disclosure

4. RECOMMENDED COURSE OF ACTION.

The most ethical approach is to document the evidence, distinguish facts from assumptions & report the concern through appropriate internal channels. The tester should remain within the authorized scope & avoid independently investigating or publicly accusing company. If internal reporting fails and illegal activity is credibly suspected, escalation to a competent authority is justified. This balances confidentiality, contractual & public protection.

5. ETHICAL PRINCIPLE INVOLVED.

- ④ INTEGRITY
- ④ CONFIDENTIALITY
- ④ PUBLIC INTEREST
- ④ ACCOUNTABILITY
- ④ PROFESSIONAL COMPETENCE

CONCLUSION:

Professional ethics requires testers to report credible evidence of serious consumer-harm discovered during authorized testing. Although they must respect contractual obligation, they should not ignore wrongdoing. The concern should be documented & escalated.